STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			P-3500	
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 06/01/06	DATE REVISED **12/17/25**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE ROAD PATROL	RESOURCES SARPY COUNTY COMMUNICATIONS CENTER STANDARD OPERATING GUIDELINES			
SUBJECT COMMUNICATION PROCEDURES	CROSS REFERENCE P-4220 BUILDING SEARCHES			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish procedures for using the radio communications equipment.

II. Policy:

Radio communication is the lifeline of any Deputy working among the public. Information transmitted over the radio must be clear and concise. Improper use of the radio wastes valuable airtime and jeopardizes the lives of other deputies or innocent civilians. All radio channels are recorded and may be monitored by the Federal Communications Commission. Recordings of radio traffic are often presented as evidence in court and may become public record. Professional demeanor and procedure is of the utmost importance with all radio traffic.

III. Procedure:

A. Receiving Information (Calls for Service) from Communications-Deputy Responsibilities: Deputies shall promptly acknowledge their district designation and respond when it is broadcast. When receiving a call from Dispatch, deputies shall use the following procedure:

1. Communications will contact deputies by calling their district designation (e.g. District 515) and will wait for a response.

2. Deputies shall respond with their district designation and location (e.g. District 515, 132nd and Hwy 370…).

3. Communications will then provide information.

4. Deputies shall respond with their district designation and clear to advise communications that the information was received (i.e. District 515, clear).

B. **Contacting Communications- Deputy Responsibilities:** When contacting Communications, deputies shall use the following procedure:

1. Deputies shall advise their district designation (e.g. District 515).

2. Deputies shall wait for dispatch to repeat the district designation.

3. Deputies shall again state their district designation and provide the appropriate information (e.g. District 515, in service, report taken).

C. **Records Checks- Deputy Responsibilities:** Deputies may obtain vehicle registration information, driver's history information, NCIC/NCIS checks, and warrant information on the Law Enforcement Information talkgroup. Deputies shall use the following procedures when requesting information:

1. **Persons:** Last name (spelled phonetically), first name (spelled), middle initial, and date of birth (day, month, year).

2. **Vehicles:** State, license number (letters phonetically), color, make and model. The VIN number may also be used with letters pronounced phonetically.

3. **Articles:** Item description, brand, model number, and serial number.

D. **Status Checks:** A deputy who has responded to an incident or who has initiated a contact will have his or her status checked every five (5) minutes by Communications unless conducting a building search and then checks will be made every fifteen (15) minutes:

1. Each time the deputy responds to dispatch the five (5) minute time limit begins anew.

2. Deputies may request status checks in potentially dangerous situations, or they may request no further status checks during extended periods where potential danger is minimal.

3. If a deputy fails to respond to a status check, the on-duty supervisor shall be notified and back-up deputies shall be dispatched.

4. Upon locating the deputy, the supervisor shall determine if further action is warranted.

E. **Emergency Button Activation/Help an Officer:** When a deputy activates the emergency button on a portable or mobile radio, the radio will automatically revert to the primary channel for his or her jurisdiction and, on a portable radio, the microphone **WILL** automatically transmit for 20 seconds. Deputies may also request emergency assistance by transmitting "HELP."

1. If the activation of the emergency button was accidental, the deputy should immediately turn his or her radio off and back on.

2. The deputy should immediately advise Communications that the activation was accidental.

3. When an emergency button is activated, a “Help an Officer” announcement will be made in the following circumstances:

   a) The deputy specifies that he or she needs immediate help.

   b) The deputy says the word “HELP” at any time.

   c) It appears to the dispatcher from activity during the 20-second “hot mic” period that the deputy needs help.

   d) Communications is uncertain if help is needed or not (e.g. if the emergency button is activated on a mobile there is not a 20-second “hot mic”. If the dispatcher cannot make radio contact with the officer involved, a “Help an Officer” shall be initiated).

   e) The deputy activating his or her emergency button or requesting “HELP” should attempt to provide his or her location and additional information, if possible.

4. Any unit on the scene may cancel the “Help an Officer” as soon as the situation is under control.

F. **Deputy/Officer Taken Hostage:** In the event a deputy or an officer is taken hostage, Communications will immediately contact all units on LE-East, LE-West and LE-Sheriff and will have them switch to LE-COMMON-1-S on their radios. All local law enforcement agencies will be contacted and informed not to use the hostage officer’s primary talk group (either LE East-S, LE West-S, or LE-Sheriff-S) until the emergency is terminated.

1. If a deputy is taken hostage and is able to transmit on the radio, he or she should advise:

   a) “DISTRICT 99 IN SERVICE.”

   b) Communications will respond: “Attention all units, clear LE-Sheriff and contact the Communications Center on LE-COMMON-1-S.”

   c) The deputy should also try to provide additional information, if possible, including his or her location.

G. **Radio Systems Failure:** In the event of a radio systems failure deputies shall adhere to the following procedures:

1. Deputies should attempt to contact Communications on other talkgroups (channels).

2. Deputies should go to the conventional talkgroup listed below based on their current location and attempt to contact dispatch. These conventional talkgroups do not utilize the digital repeater system.

   a) Sarpy Co Wide 8CALL90 (Central): 84th Street to Hwy 50
   b) Sarpy Co Wide 8TAC91 (East): Missouri River to 84th Street
   c) Sarpy Co Wide 8TAC92 (West): Hwy 50 west to Platte River

3. If all radio communications fail, the deputy should attempt to make phone contact.

H. General Procedures:

1. Deputies shall use only “plain talk” and approved codes when transmitting (listed at the end of this policy).

2. Deputies shall not challenge or question Communications regarding being assigned to a call. Only a supervisor may cancel a call or reassign it to another deputy or agency.

3. Deputies shall use the phonetic alphabet when needed (listed at the end of this policy). When pronouncing a letter using the phonetic alphabet, deputies should first say the letter then the phonetic (i.e. “M-Mary”).

4. Deputies shall avoid the use of the word “HELP” unless they need immediate assistance.

5. Confidential information, including home addresses, telephone numbers, and entry codes, should not be transmitted, if possible.

6. Except in emergencies, deputies shall not break in on current radio traffic or interrupt ongoing communication exchanges.

I. Talkgroup Assignments (Channels): The following is a description of the talkgroups most commonly used by the Sarpy County Sheriff’s Office Road Patrol. For additional information see the talkgroup list:

1. **(LE-SHERIFF-S):** This is the primary encrypted dispatch channel for Sheriff’s Office Deputies. The public can access this radio feed online with a 30-minute delay. Sensitive information should not be transmitted on this channel, due to the delayed online feed. This is also the channel that will be utilized by the Papillion PD & LaVista PD units if LE-West-S is cleared for emergency traffic.

2. **(LE-WEST-S):** Law Enforcement West Secure is the primary channel for Papillion PD & LaVista PD units. While this channel~~/talkgroup~~ is encrypted, the public can access the radio feed online with a 30-minute delay. Sensitive information should not be transmitted on this channel/~~talkgroup~~, due to the online feed. This is also the channel that will be utilized by the Road Patrol units if LE-SHERIFF-S is cleared for emergency traffic.

3. **(LE-INFO-S):** Law Enforcement Information is the channel used to obtain records checks or information for persons, vehicles, or items.

4. **(SCSO-TAC1-S):** Sarpy County Sheriff's Office Tactical Channel 1 (i.e. Tac 1) is an encrypted channel/talkgroup used by the Sheriff's Office only and may be used for tactical communications during calls or to provide dispatch with more detailed information regarding a call. This channel/talkgroup can also be used to provide sensitive/confidential information.

5. **(SCSO-TAC2-S):** Sarpy County Sheriff's Office Tactical Channel 2 Secure is used by the Sheriff's Office only and may be used for tactical communications during calls or to provide dispatch with more detailed information regarding a call or to provide information of a more confidential nature. SCSO-TAC-2-S is also used for building searches (see P-4220 Building Searches).

6. **(LE-COMM1-S):** Law Enforcement Common 1 is an encrypted channel/talkgroup used by all the law enforcement agencies in Sarpy County to communicate with one another. This is also the talkgroup that will be utilized by the Road Patrol units if LE-SHERIFF-S and LE-West-S are cleared for emergency traffic. Bomb Threat (Signal 9) information is also provided on this channel.

7. **(SCSO Primary)** Sarpy County Sheriff's Office Primary is used by the Sheriff's Office only and is used to transmit emergency button activation traffic.

8. **(LAW-FIRE-1):** Law Fire 1 is used to relay information to a Sarpy County fire or rescue unit by law enforcement.

9. **(LE-EAST-S):** Law Enforcement East is Bellevue Police Department's encrypted primary channel. Deputies may be requested to monitor this channel when assisting the Bellevue Police Department. This channel is broadcasted online on a thirty (30) minute delay, similar to LE-WEST-S.

10. **(METRO Channels):** These channels are sequential (i.e., METRO-1, METRO-2, etc) interoperability channels that law enforcement in the Omaha/Council Bluffs Metro Area have access to in order to communicate in joint-agency efforts. These includes pursuits, use of assets from other agencies (i.e., ABLE-1 Helicopter), and other inter-agency incidents/operations. Deputies shall have knowledge of how to access these channels on their assigned radios.

IV. Signals and Codes:

Signal 1	**No Record**
Signal 1A	**Traffic Record Only**
Signal 1B	**Misdemeanor Record**
Signal 1C	**Traffic and Misdemeanors**
Signal 2	**Felony Record**
Signal 2C	**Felony Conviction(s)**
Signal 3	**Active Misdemeanor Warrant**
Signal 4S	**Suspended Driver**
Signal 4R	**Revoked Driver**
Signal 5	**Stolen article or vehicle**
Signal 6	**Active Felony Warrant**
Signal 7	**Drug Involvement**
Signal 9	**Bomb Threat**
Signal 10	**Generic Gun Permit (Gun registration)**
Signal D	**Communicable Disease Patient/Residence**
Signal 10P	**Permit to Carry (Omaha)**
Signal 10C	**Concealed Handgun Permit**
Signal 66	**Gang Involvement**
Signal 88	**Situation Secure**
Signal 99	**Send Urgent Back-Up**
Signal S	**Registered Sex Offender**
Signal TX	**Suspected Terrorist**
X	**Dangerous Person**
CCW	**Record of Carrying Concealed Weapons**
Code 95	**Restroom Break**
Code 240	**Lunch Break**
Code 1	**Very minor injury, complain of pain**
Code 2	**Visible Injury, but stable**
Code 3	**Critical Injury/Trauma**
Code 4	**Deceased**
Code 5	**Deceased, Squad is transporting (usually for children)**

Disposition Codes: Codes provided communications regarding the outcome of a call.

ADDRESS VERIFIED
ALARM CARD
ARREST -CUSTODY
ARREST-STREET RELEASED
ASSISTED
BAN AND BAR
BROADCAST
CITATION ISSUED
CIVIL MATTER
CONTROLLED BURN
COPPS ACTIVITY
COURTESY TICKET ISSED
DEER TAG ISSUED
DOMESTIC VIOLENCE INCIDENT
FALSE ALARM
F.I. CARD
FOLLOW UP
GONE ON ARRIVAL
K-9 REPORT
LOST PROPERTY
NO REPORT
NO TRANSPORT
NO VIOLATION
OTHER
PROJECT LIFESAVER
PASSED FIELD SOBRIETY
OLN PICKUP ORDER
REFERRED TO OTHER AGENCY
REFERRED INTERNALLY
REPORT TAKEN
SECURE
SELECTIVE ENFORCEMENT
SPECIAL
TIRES MARKED
TRANSPORTED
USE OF FORCE
UNFOUNDED
VALID ALARM
VIOLATION CORRECTED
VEHICLE MOVED

NOTHING FOUND
NO ACTION
NO CONTACT
NO JURISDICTION
NOT NEEDED
VEHICLE TOWED
VERBAL WARNING
WARRANT CHECK
WRONG NUMBER-911 CALLS
WRITTEN WARNING
RED/YELLOW TAG

After completing a call for service or traffic stop, Communications shall be advised all relevant disposition codes. Additional information regarding the disposition can be provided on Sheriff's Tac channels, by telephone, or by updating MDC comments section.

V. Phonetic Alphabet:

A	**Adam**	**N**	**Nora**
B	**Boy**	**O**	**Ocean**
C	**Charles**	**P**	**Paul**
D	**David**	**Q**	**Queen**
E	**Edward**	**R**	**Robert**
F	**Frank**	**S**	**Sam**
G	**George**	**T**	**Tom**
H	**Henry**	**U**	**Union**
I	**Ida**	**V**	**Victor**
J	**John**	**W**	**William**
K	**King**	**X**	**X-ray**
L	**Lincoln**	**Y**	**Young**
M	**Mary**	**Z**	**Zebra**